

With over a decade of serious gaming behind them, gaming enthusiasts took to a new form of recreation—that of modifying the game at hand. The earliest mod was probably *Castle Smurfenstein*, a mod for *Castle Wolfenstein*. Soon, game designers too realised that custom content increased the lifespan of their games, and thus began to actively encourage the creation of mods.

The game that has spawned the most successful and widely-played mod of all time is *Half-Life*. The mod was a squad-based shooter titled *CounterStrike*.

Gaming has spawned innovation in a number of spheres, from the most obvious ones such as graphics and sound to operating systems, media such as compact disks, and also networking technologies.